



What is it?

Looking Through the Lenses is an interactive installation that reimagines the traditional bioscope for a contemporary audience. Inspired by the nostalgic street-side viewing device, this handcrafted wooden bioscope allows six viewers to experience short surreal video artworks simultaneously. Inside the device, four looping videos play across the six viewing screens, each exploring imaginative and speculative narratives created using cinematic storytelling and AI-generated visuals, including speculative scenarios such as the disappearance of tea culture in Gujarat. Each viewer can switch between the videos using rotary regulators, making the experience tactile and personal. By blending heritage craftsmanship with digital technology, the project transforms the bioscope into a participatory device that encourages curiosity, slows down digital consumption, and creates a shared moment of wonder.

Project Type Interactive Installation	Role Concept Creation, Video Content Creation, Tech Integration, Design and Installation	Project Duration Completed
Display Installed -VR Mall, Surat	Tools AI Video Tools, Adobe After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Hardware Regulators, Multi-screen Display System.	Total Components Wooden Bioscope Structure, 6 Viewing Screens, Tech, Regulators

Project Overview.

Looking Through the Lenses is an interactive installation that reimagines the traditional bioscope for a contemporary setting. The project takes inspiration from the old street-side bioscopes that allowed people to look through small lenses and watch moving images. For the Dumas Art Festival, this nostalgic device is recreated as a handcrafted wooden bioscope designed for six viewers at a time.

Inside the bioscope, four looping surreal video artworks play across the six viewing screens. Each viewer can switch between the videos using rotary regulators, making the experience interactive and personal. The videos are created using cinematic storytelling and AI-generated visuals, exploring imaginative and speculative themes.

One of the videos imagines a surreal situation where tea becomes extinct, focusing on Gujarat's strong cultural connection to tea and the people who depend on it in their daily lives. While the bioscope presents four different video experiences.



The Concept

The concept of Looking Through the Lenses is to bring together the nostalgia of a traditional bioscope with the possibilities of contemporary technology. The bioscope, once a popular street-side viewing device, created moments of curiosity and collective wonder. In this project, that traditional form is preserved through a handcrafted wooden structure and the familiar act of looking through individual lenses.

At the same time, the experience inside the bioscope is driven by modern technology. Instead of static images, viewers encounter AI-generated surreal video artworks that explore speculative ideas from everyday life. The addition of rotary regulators allows viewers to switch between the four videos, introducing a simple interactive system within the traditional device. By blending heritage craftsmanship with digital media and interaction, the project reimagines the bioscope as a contemporary storytelling experience.

The Design Process

This section provides a road map for your explorations of our case study. Dive into each chapter to uncover the story of our project, from research and ideation to design and testing, leading to a user-centric solutions that sure to inspire.

 Idea Exploration Initial concept research	 Concept Development Defining installation approach	 Content Creation Surreal video development	 Tech Integration Hardware and software system setup	 Installation and Execution Final bioscope installation
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Understanding the Bioscope Idea

- Researching the history and cultural significance of traditional bioscopes
- Exploring how nostalgia and curiosity shaped the viewing experience
- Identifying ways to reinterpret the device for a contemporary audience



Developing the Interactive System

- Designing the bioscope structure for six simultaneous viewers
- Integrating screens and rotary regulators for video switching
- Combining handcrafted construction with simple technological interaction

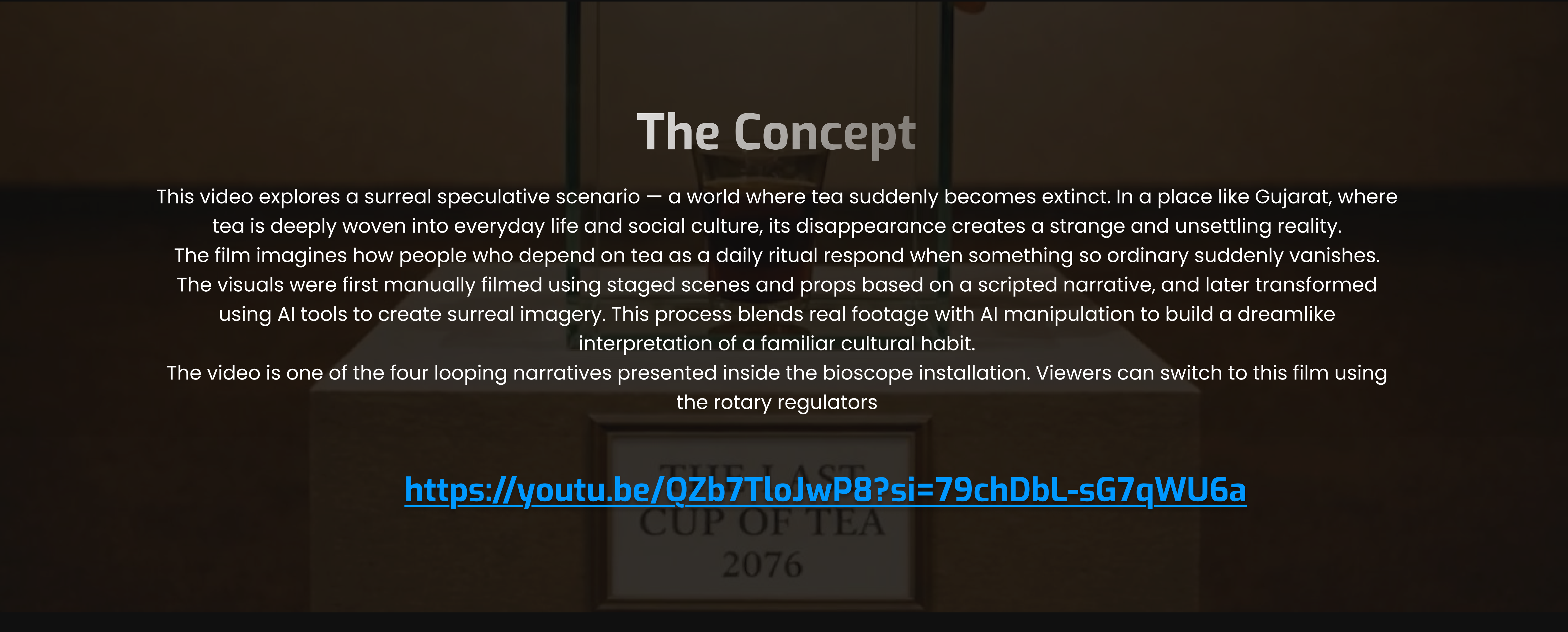
Creating the Surreal Video Content

- Developing four speculative video narratives for the bioscope
- Experimenting with AI-generated visuals and cinematic storytelling
- Exploring themes from everyday culture, including the surreal idea of tea extinction in Gujarat



Inside the Bioscope - Chai na Milegi Dubara

A speculative film imagining a world where tea becomes extinct in Gujarat.



The Concept

This video explores a surreal speculative scenario — a world where tea suddenly becomes extinct. In a place like Gujarat, where tea is deeply woven into everyday life and social culture, its disappearance creates a strange and unsettling reality. The film imagines how people who depend on tea as a daily ritual respond when something so ordinary suddenly vanishes. The visuals were first manually filmed using staged scenes and props based on a scripted narrative, and later transformed using AI tools to create surreal imagery. This process blends real footage with AI manipulation to build a dreamlike interpretation of a familiar cultural habit.

The video is one of the four looping narratives presented inside the bioscope installation. Viewers can switch to this film using the rotary regulators

<https://youtu.be/QZb7TloJwP8?si=79chDbL-sG7qWU6a>